

GSEB CLASS 10 SOCIAL SCIENCE

Chapter 1: Heritage of India - Section B

SECTION B

Q1. Find and write the names of the animals depicted on the national emblem of India.

- **Selected Animals:** From the given options, the animals depicted on the national emblem of India are four lions, a horse, an elephant, and a bull.
- **Structure on Base:** The emblem features four lions standing back-to-back, with the figures of a bull, a horse, and an elephant carved on its circular base.
- **Symbolic Value:** Below the animals, the Dharmachakra (Wheel of Law) is carved, symbolizing righteousness and national integrity.
- **Cultural Importance:** These animal figures are featured on our national currency, reflecting India's ancient legacy of wildlife protection and reverence.

Q2. Give brief information of Negritoid (Habsi).

- **Origin & Arrival:** Historians consider the Negritoid or Negroes (Habsi) to be among the earliest inhabitants of India who migrated from Africa via Baluchistan.
- **Physical Attributes:** They possessed distinct physical features, including black skin, a short stature of 4 to 5 feet, and curly hair.
- **Settlement Era:** They established early human settlements in the Indian subcontinent long before the arrival of Australoids and Aryans.
- **Cultural Contribution:** They formed one of the fundamental ancestral racial strands in the early formation of India's multi-ethnic population.

Q3. "A harmonious culture was created in India." Explain this statement.

- **Migration of Tribes:** Over centuries, various foreign tribes arrived in India, settled permanently, and blended with the local indigenous population.
- **Social Amalgamation:** Through inter-caste/inter-tribe marriages and shared social living, foreign and native traditions gradually merged into a unified identity.
- **Cultural Exchange:** Outsiders and locals deeply influenced each other's languages, scripts, names, daily customs, and religious beliefs.
- **Composite Synthesis:** This long-standing integration created a variegated, inclusive, and peaceful composite culture across the Indian subcontinent.

Q4. How can we say that the Aryans were nature-lovers?

- **Worship of Natural Elements:** The Nordic-Aryans held immense reverence for natural phenomena, worshipping trees, rivers, mountains, the Sun, wind, and rain.
- **Composition of Hymns:** They composed sacred verses and hymns (Richas) dedicated to praising and invoking these individual forces of nature.
- **Ritualistic Traditions:** Over time, these devotional prayers evolved into structured religious practices such as Vedic chants, yagyas, and seasonal rites.
- **Environmental Harmony:** Their spiritual belief system viewed nature not merely as resources, but as divine manifestations worthy of preservation.

Q5. Which are the things that are included in our cultural heritage?

- **Core Definition:** Cultural heritage encompasses everything created, developed, or acquired by human beings using their intellect, skill, art, and wisdom.
- **Architectural Structures:** It includes ancient palaces, temples, mosques, stupas, viharas, forts, historical gates, and monuments linked to the freedom movement like Sabarmati Ashram.
- **Intellectual & Scientific Discoveries:** It comprises scripts, languages, zero, mathematics, astronomy, metalwork, literature, Vastu Shastra, political science, zoology, and botany.
- **Social Practices:** Traditions, religious rituals, daily lifestyle practices, and festival celebrations passed down through generations are also included.

Q6. Differentiate between India's natural heritage and cultural heritage.

Feature	Natural Heritage	Cultural Heritage
Meaning	Result of a close relationship between nature, environment, and human life, gifted naturally.	Man-made heritage created or acquired by human beings using intellect, art, skill, and tact.
Origin & Nature	Formed entirely by natural processes without human intervention.	Created consciously by human effort, intellectual progress, and societal evolution.
Components	Includes mountains, rivers, forests, flora, fauna, soil, and scenic landscapes.	Includes architectural monuments, sculptures, scripts, literary texts, and ancient inventions.
Key Examples	Himalayas, Ganga and Indus rivers, Banyan tree, Asian lions in Gir forest.	Lothal, Sun Temple of Modhera, Ashoka's Inscriptions, Sabarmati Ashram, discovery of Zero.

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